

6. Act in a manner that **reflects positively** on the financial planning profession

Standards of Conduct — Duties Owed to Clients (Key Standards)

Standard	Name	Key Rule
A.1	Fiduciary Duty	Must act as fiduciary when providing Financial Advice: Loyalty + Care + Follow Instructions
A.2	Integrity	No false statements; no fraud or deceit; anti-fraud provisions
A.3	Competence	Provide services with relevant knowledge/skill; if not competent → gain it, limit scope, refer, or terminate
A.4	Diligence	Respond to client inquiries in timely, thorough manner
A.5	Disclose & Manage Conflicts	Fully disclose material conflicts; obtain informed consent; manage conflict (even if acting in client's best interest)
A.6	Sound & Objective Judgment	Act objectively; no gifts that compromise objectivity
A.7	Professionalism	Treat all with dignity, courtesy, respect
A.8	Comply With the Law	Follow all laws and regulations; no assisting others in violations
A.9	Confidentiality & Privacy	Keep client info confidential; 2 exceptions: ordinary business use, legal/compliance purposes
A.10/A.11	Provide Information	Accurate info in understandable manner per terms of engagement
A.12	Compensation Method	Fee-only = ONLY planning fees; Fee-based = planning fees + commissions/sales-related compensation
A.13	Recommending Additional Persons	Reasonable basis for referral; disclose compensation; communicate roles; inform client of non-performance
A.14	Technology	Reasonable basis for reliability; reasonable care; reasonable understanding (NOT required to be expert)